

EPISODE ONE CANDIDATE

Working title: NO FIXED ADDRESS

Status: DEVELOPMENT v1.0, not approved · **Date:** 2026-08-25 · **Origin:** Claude 3 of the reader test, classified RETAIN AS EPISODE ONE SEED by both generators, and the only premise of thirty-three to draw a positive from both readers

Reader evidence. Stephen: *"This may have legs. Best of the bunch so far."* and, after twelve further hooks, *"one of the strongest contenders for episode 1 yet."* Trish: *"Good. What happens next?"*

Why it exists outside the field. Retained seeds were excluded from the targeted v2.2 replacement field, which generates replacements for retired premises. Nothing in the brief then said what happens to a retained seed, so the strongest candidate was being held on a shelf while two generators produced material to compete with it. This document closes that gap.

1. IDENTITY

Family	FRESH
Inherited situation	Person, identity, body or evidence missing
Primary payoff	Find or name
Human stake	Identity
Primary engine	E5, naming the victim (<i>Bear Brook</i>)
Second influence	E3, investigation changes the place (<i>Your Own Backyard</i>)
Failure mechanism (v2.2 axis four)	Unequal looking. Nobody looked hard because of who they believed she was. Not a failed process, an unequal one.
Axis one, record shape	Misclassified
Axis two, reconstruction	A person's identity, rebuilt from what she was wearing
Axis three, resolution	She is named, and naming her is what makes everything else legally possible

Note on engines. E5+E3 is also CL-Co3's allocated pair. There is no conflict: this premise is not in the targeted field and consumes no allocation.

2. THE STORY

Logline. A woman is found under the Stonebridge Viaduct and the record says unidentified female, thirty to forty-five, no fixed address, death by misadventure. Three of those five things are wrong. She had an address. She had a job. And she has a mother interstate who is still ringing a phone that stopped being answered in November.

The crime. Kerry Nolan, thirty-four, left Dean Iles in September and moved without telling him where. She took a night cleaning job at the Hart Civic Center and a room in Rivermouth. In November her sister-in-law posted a photograph with a recognisable window behind it. Dean found her in nine days. He went to talk to her and he did not leave her alive.

The cheap thing and the clever thing. He took her bag, which was panic. Then he sat in his van for two hours and did the only intelligent thing of that night: he drove her to the Stonebridge Viaduct and left her among the camps, because he had driven under it twice a day for six years and he knew what this city writes down when it finds a woman under a bridge.

Why she is still nameless. Her mother reported her missing interstate, from a different jurisdiction, with a photograph three years old and an address Kerry had left. Havenbay recorded an unidentified woman with no identification beneath a viaduct. Both agencies did their work correctly. **The two records never met, because nothing existed to make them meet.** This is not incompetence and no reader is asked to believe in a lazy investigator. It is the single most ordinary way a person stays unnamed.

3. KILL GATE ZERO: FIRST FIVE CAUSAL EVENTS

	1. Kerry leaves and does not tell him	2. Dean locates her	3. Dean kills her	4. Dean removes ID and relocates her	5. The city records her
Actor	Kerry Nolan	Dean Iles	Dean Iles	Dean Iles	Attending officers, then the coroner
Authority	Her own	None. He has no lawful means and uses none	None. Homicide	None	Statutory. Officers attend a death; the coroner records a finding
Custody	She controls her new address; two people in Havenbay know it	He controls only what he can see in a photograph	He controls the flat for under an hour	He controls the body and the van for one night	The state takes custody of the body and her effects
Normal response	A person moving on has no duty to inform anyone	A photograph on a public account is visible to anyone permitted to see it	A neighbour hears something or does not	A body moved between districts risks being seen	An unidentified deceased triggers identification attempts: description, dental, prints, missing persons comparison
Safeguard	A stay-away condition exists from an earlier breach	Account privacy settings, which were not applied	Neighbours, a locked door	Traffic cameras, other road users, the camps themselves	Interstate missing-persons comparison exists as a system
Bypass	None needed. He simply looked	None needed. The photograph was public	None. He was let in	None invented. He took the ordinary risk and it did not catch him that night. It is what catches him in the episode	None. Nobody skips a step. The interstate report carries a three-year-old photograph, a surname she had stopped using at work, and a superseded address, and the Havenbay record carries no name at all. Two correct records that do not match
Consequence	She is safe and unreachable, and also invisible	He knows the district	She is dead	She becomes a category instead of a person	Misadventure. Case closed at the level of effort the category attracts
Evidence source	The stay-away record; two friends	The sister-in-law's post, still live	The flat, the neighbours, the hour	The van, the route between two	The coronial finding; the interstate report

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			districts, the camps	held by her mother

Institutional-power check. No invented power. No corruption. No professional is absent or incurious. Ally's licence grants her nothing. The failure is unequal looking: a correct process applied at the priority the category attracts.

Antagonist least-cost test

Why murder. He did not go there to kill her. He went to make her speak to him, having already breached a condition once to find her at all. The killing is the failure of that visit, which is what the overwhelming majority of these deaths actually are.

Why now. Nine days after a photograph told him she was still in Havenbay and had a life he was not in.

Why this victim. She left him.

Why this method and staging. The method is unplanned. The staging is the only deliberate act of the night, taken two hours later, and it is cheap: a van he already had, a place he already knew, twenty minutes of driving.

Why not an easier route. Intimidation had already been tried and produced the condition. Flight leaves him with nothing. He is not concealing a crime for gain; he is a man who has done something irreversible and reaches for the one advantage available, which is her anonymity rather than his own alibi.

What the method costs him. He moved a body across two districts in a vehicle registered to him. That is the largest risk anyone takes in this episode and it is the thread the reconstruction pulls.

4. ACCESS MAP

Decisive item: the interstate missing-person report Maureen Nolan filed in November, and the photograph attached to it.

- 1. Lawful possessor.** Maureen Nolan holds her own copy as the reporting person.
- 2. Disclosure route.** She gives it to Ally. Owner consent, the cheapest lawful route there is, requiring no privilege Ally lacks.
- 3. What remains inaccessible.** The Havenbay coronial file, the post-mortem, the effects held with the body, and the interstate agency's own holdings. Under the 2026-08-25 rulings, next of kin may obtain coronial findings and tendered evidence. **Maureen cannot, because you cannot be next of kin to a person who has no name.** Every lawful route in this episode is keyed to an identity that does not yet exist.
- 4. Ally's route requires no police privilege.** Maureen's copy, Nova Skye's knowledge of who does and does not belong to the camps, a workplace that noticed an absence, and a bus pass.

5. **What Ally gets wrong because she can reach only part of the record.** The report lists Dean Iles as a contact, because in November Maureen still believed her daughter was with him. Ally meets him as the last person who loved her. **She will treat him as a source for four leads before she treats him as anything else, and the document that makes her trust him is the same document that breaks the case.**

5. GATES ONE TO NINE

1. Desk. First thirty seconds: a mother's voicemail, left in January, to a phone that has been dead since November, still telling her daughter she is not angry. Then the record read flat: *unidentified female, thirty to forty-five, no fixed address, misadventure*. Murder-led, concrete contradiction, no jargon. Performed compulsion UNKNOWN until the spoken test.

2. Human consequence. Named living person: Maureen Nolan. Operating mechanism: she is still ringing the phone, still paying the account to keep the number alive, and cannot begin to grieve or claim anything until her daughter has a name. **Investigative consequence:** Ally's approach to the camps brings police attention, and police attention to the camps means a sweep. **Legibility:** a mother is ringing her dead daughter's phone because nobody has told her, and nobody has told her because nobody knows who she is.

3. Clock. Day-stamped, case-born. Kerry's effects are held pending identification and the account holding her phone number lapses when Maureen stops paying it. Not the same object as the resistance. Pause-safe.

4. Midpoint. Ally stops trying to prove how Kerry died and starts trying to prove who she was. The action changes: away from the viaduct and the camps, toward a locker, a laundry tag and a bus pass. The route, the target and the evidence strategy all change.

5. Fair play. The plant is the bus pass, present in lead two as a small human detail and not explained until lead nine. Dean's presence in the missing-person report is fair, early, and misread by design. No coincidence proves him. The wrong hypothesis is structural: for four leads the strongest reading is that she died as the record says and the only wrong is that nobody named her.

6. Humanisation. Kerry kept her old bus pass topped up long after she had started walking to work, because she liked knowing she could leave. It is on her body. Its travel history is the reconstruction's spine. Grievable and load-bearing at once, and small enough that it could not have been invented for effect. **Keeper with a need beyond information:** Nova Skye, who needs the camps not to be swept, and who is therefore a reluctant source rather than a helpful one. No gore. No child harm.

7. Havenbay necessity. A body beneath the Stonebridge Viaduct is read as a camp death, and camp deaths attract the identification effort that a transient population realistically attracts. **The district determines the priority, the priority determines the record, and the record is the crime's concealment.** Relocate this story to any district where a dead woman is presumed to have a name and it collapses entirely. Dean's one intelligent act is only intelligent in this specific place, and he knew it because he drove under it twice a day.

8. Production. Played leads 16. Authored leads 19, including three that spawn only on the branch that asks the camps. Portraits: Ally CANON, Del Cruz CANON v2 approved, Nova Skye CANON. New portraits required: Maureen Nolan, Dean Iles, one camp resident. Locations: Stonebridge Viaduct (canon), Hart Civic

Center exterior (canon), Kestrel Corner Diner (canon, Del's table), The Rusty Anchor (canon), one new interior for Kerry's room. Reconstruction mode: object-to-identity. Resolution mode: she is named, and the naming is what unlocks everything the law had been withholding.

9. Resistance. Dean Iles. He benefits from the accepted record absolutely: while she is unidentified, no investigation exists to be near. **His least-cost response when challenged is not a threat.** He contacts Maureen himself, as her daughter's grieving former partner, and offers to help. He is warm, useful, and volunteers small true things. Restraint is more rational than action for him throughout, and it is worse.

6. AGENCY

Four planned decisions. Two Class A, two Class B, no Class C. Every branch rejoins within three leads and no fork opens before its branch rejoins.

Decision 1, Class A, lead 4. Ask the camps, or work the workplace.

Nova can ask who saw a van that night. Asking works and it brings attention, and attention to the camps means a sweep within the week. **Branch A.** Ally gets the van and a partial plate in lead 5. **Bram loses his place under the viaduct in lead 7 and the player sees it happen.** Irreversible within the episode. **Branch B.** No van. Ally reaches the same district four leads later through the laundry tag, and Bram keeps his place. **Rejoin:** lead 7.

Decision 2, Class A, lead 8. Tell Maureen now, or wait for confirmation.

Ally has a probable name and no proof. **Branch A.** Maureen is told and flies in. She becomes the episode's best source and its greatest exposure, and if Ally is wrong she has told a mother her daughter is dead on a guess. **Branch B.** Ally says nothing, and must keep speaking to a woman who is still ringing the phone while knowing. **Maureen learns from an officer in lead 12 and the player watches her realise Ally already knew.** That relationship does not recover inside the episode. **Rejoin:** lead 12.

Decision 3, Class B, lead 10. Spend Del, or go public.

Del can compare a name against the unidentified record off the books, at a real personal cost. The alternative is asking listeners, which works and which Dean also hears. **Rejoin:** lead 12.

Decision 4, Class B, lead 14. Publish the name before or after the record is amended.

Publishing first gives Kerry back to the people who knew her and tells Dean exactly what Ally holds. Waiting protects the case and leaves her a number for another three weeks. **Rejoin:** the close.

End states. Whether Kerry is named in the record or only on the show; whether Dean knew before or after; whether the camps were swept and Bram displaced; whether Maureen learned from Ally or from a stranger. **At least two differ materially in who is protected, exposed and believed.**

Counterfactual. Remove the player's decisions and Bram keeps his place, Maureen learns from an officer, and Kerry is named three weeks later regardless. Named people's outcomes change.

Fairness, decision 1. The player knows the camps saw something and knows Nova is unwilling. Branch A risks a named man's shelter for a real lead; branch B risks losing the van entirely to protect him. A reasonable

player chooses either. Later evidence reframes it: the laundry tag would have worked anyway, four leads later, which the player cannot know at the time. **The displacement cannot be undone.**

No consequence-free option, no obviously correct option. Decision 1's protective branch costs the investigation four leads and, on one route, the van. **The cost of protecting Bram is borne by Maureen, who waits longer.**

7. PROCESS DEPENDENCIES

Answered by canon, per bible §2.3.2:

- Coronial findings and tendered evidence are obtainable by next of kin; running sheets and working notes are not. **This is the obstacle, not the solution**, because next-of-kin status requires an identity.
- Weather and visibility observations are permanent and public.
- CCTV is retained thirty-one days and indefinitely once flagged. **The van is outside the window.** The reconstruction cannot use traffic footage and does not.

PENDING APPROVAL, three one-line rulings needed before script:

1. Who may formally identify a deceased person in Havenbay, and what happens when a family in another jurisdiction comes forward?
2. Can a coronial finding of misadventure be amended once the deceased is identified, and by whom?
3. What happens to the effects of an unidentified deceased person, and who may view them once she is named?

Per the standing practice ruled 2026-08-25: asked, not invented, and the premise is not killed for the pending answer.

Small-number test. NOT DECISIVE. Nothing turns on a time, distance or measurement. The reconstruction runs on a bus pass's travel history, a laundry tag, a locker, a workplace that noticed an absence, and a mother's photograph.

8. KILL BRIEF

Competent professional. *Would she really still be unnamed?* Yes, and this is the objection the premise is built to survive. A missing-person report filed interstate with a three-year-old photograph, a surname she had stopped using at work and a superseded address, against a Havenbay record with no name and a category that attracts proportionate effort. Both agencies acted correctly. Nothing in this episode requires an investigator to skip a step, and that is a deliberate correction to three premises this project has already lost on exactly that objection.

Rational antagonist. He did not plan a murder and does not behave like a man who did. He takes one cheap intelligent step, then spends the episode being helpful, which is both his least-cost strategy and the most frightening thing he could do.

Ordinary player. Is there anyone to be angry at? Yes, and he is on the show from lead three, warm and useful. Is the reason to care sayable in one sentence with no jargon? *A mother is ringing her dead daughter's phone because nobody has told her, and nobody has told her because nobody knows who she is.*

Producer. Sixteen played leads, five canon locations, one new interior, three new portraits. Two of the four decisions reuse existing branch machinery. The `requiresFlag` and `forbidsFlag` gate shipped and is tested.

VERDICT: PASS

Decisive reason: it is the only premise of thirty-three that both readers wanted more of, and every structural objection that killed the other thirty-two is answered rather than deferred. No administrative stake. No trade vocabulary. No small quantitative correction. No competent professional required to be lazy. An intimate relationship at the centre. A living person to be angry at, present from lead three.

Recorded weaknesses, not defended. The victim is a woman killed by a former partner, which is the most common real homicide and also the most frequently told, so the freshness lives entirely in the identity structure rather than the crime. And the episode asks a player to spend fifteen leads before the murder is even certain to be a murder, which is a genuine risk at the opening and is exactly what the spoken test exists to measure.

9. WHAT IS NOT IN HERE

No cold open. No spoken opening. No lead-by-lead map. No dialogue. Those follow the spoken-opening protocol if this is approved, and not before.